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THE LORD OF THE RINGS™ ROLEPLAYING

OVER HILL AND UNDER HILL

ADVENTURE DESIGN
Francesco Nepitello, Jacob Rodgers

EDITOR
Tomas Härenstam

CONCEPT ART
Alvaro Tapia

COVER ART
Antonio De Luca

OTHER ART
Niklas Brandt

GRAPHIC DESIGN
Christian Granath, Dan Algstrand, Niklas Brandt

LAYOUT AND PREPRESS
Dan Algstrand

MAPS
Francesco Mattioli

PROOFREADING
Brandon Bowling

PROJECT MANAGER
Tomas Härenstam

BRAND MANAGER
Robert Hyde – Sophisticated Games

EVENT MANAGER
Anna Westerling

CUSTOMER SUPPORT MANAGER
Daniel Lehto

PLAYTESTING
Anna Westerling, Marco Behrmann, Kosta Kostulas,
Nils Karlén, Tomas Härenstam

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OVER HILL AND UNDER HILL

'Not far ahead were dreary hills, rising higher and higher, dark with trees. On some of them were old castles with an evil look, as if they had been built by wicked people.'

— *The Hobbit*™

This booklet offers an introductory adventure designed to be played with the pre-generated Player-heroes included in this boxed set. If you are reading this, you are likely serving as the Loremaster. The majority of the text in this booklet is devoted to presenting the adventure, so players are encouraged not to read ahead to preserve the fun and excitement of discovery.

The game statistics for all Adversaries in the adventure can be found at the back of this booklet.

OVERVIEW

Over Hill and Under Hill is divided into three parts, followed by an epilogue. Each part is expected to take about one hour of gameplay, with the final part likely taking twice as long. Completing the entire story in one day would require a serious time commitment. Therefore, we recommend planning one session for each part.

CHOOSING PLAYER-HEROES

Let the players choose freely among the five available pre-generated Player-heroes in this boxed set. On the back of each character sheet, the players will find a brief biography, a description of unique features and virtues for the Player-heroes at level 1 and others unlocked at level 2, and an illustration. Each Player-hero also has a corresponding cardboard stand-up figure. If you have fewer than five players, you can remove any Player-heroes you like, but the adventure is not designed to be played with fewer than three players.

PART 1: A FATEFUL MEETING

The Player-heroes enjoy a rare quiet evening at *The Prancing Pony* when a hunter shares a story about discovering a hill in the North Downs with ancient standing stones and a terrifying vision he had. The next morning, the Company sets out from Bree, heading north. After days of travel in the wild, they reach the Crowned Hill.

> The Loremaster is suggested to end the session after the Journey section, as the Company approaches the Crowned Hill.

PART 2: THE CROWNED HILL

On a barren hilltop in the North Downs, the Company finds proof of a long-forgotten threat. As they investigate, they are attacked by its servants. If they prevail, they continue their search and reach a ruined village of the Hill-folk, where they may discover more about the menace they face.

> Ideally, the second session should end here, with the Company ready to journey further east. At this point, the Player-heroes level up to level 2 (see the Rules booklet).

PART 3: IRON JAWS

The Player-heroes travel east, venturing deep into the dark region of Rhudaur. Once they reach their destination, they must brave an underground complex beneath sinister ruins. Here, they will face formidable dangers but might also find valuable treasures that could prove useful against the Warg-queen, a deadly servant of the Witch-king.

PART 1:
A FATEFUL MEETING

The Player-heroes belong to a Company, a tight-knit group of adventurers based in the town of Bree. They know each other and have worked together for some time, protecting the simple folk of the area from bone-chilling dangers coming from the houseless hills beyond.

At the beginning of the adventure, the Player-heroes are relaxing at *The Prancing Pony* in early September, having recently assisted the Bounders of the Shire with some troubles on their northern borders.

A LAST TALE FOR THE NIGHT

The Loremaster should read or paraphrase the following text to open the adventure.

The evening has been pleasant, and you and your companions have enjoyed much of the Pony's fine beer. But you didn't come to the inn merely for cheer. Lady Gilraen, your patron and wise counsellor, arranged a meeting with a fellow named Rupert Rushlight — a hunter who has a tale of great interest to tell.

When an old man with a limp and a bandaged eye approaches your table, you politely invite him to sit.

'Greetings, I am Rupert Rushlight,' he says in a weathered voice. 'We share a friend in Lady Gilraen.' He glances around the room cautiously before lowering his voice to tell his tale.

'Three weeks ago, while hunting in the eastern foothills of the North Downs, I was caught in a sudden storm. Seeking refuge from the biting wind, I stumbled upon a ring of ancient stones atop a hill. Though not a place I'd usually choose for rest, I hoped to find a cave or some kind of shelter there. On the bare summit, I noticed several tracks encircling a shallow pit at the centre of the ring of stones. As I moved closer to inspect it, a cloud veiled the moon, enveloping everything in deep darkness.'

'I barely remember what happened next. The air turned deathly cold, colder than any winter's night, as I recall watching my breath freezing before me. And I felt it — an ancient presence, powerful and malevolent, searching for me. When a terrifying growl echoed across the hills around me, I knew I had been discovered!'

Rupert pauses, his hand trembling as he takes a sip from his tankard.

'I ran, fleeing down the crowned hill as fast as I could, nearly all the way to Bree. I told the Rangers, and word reached Lady Gilraen. She asked me to tell you my story and so I did, but I beg you — don't ask me to return to those cursed stones.'

With these final words, Rupert hands you a letter. The seal upon it unmistakably belongs to Gilraen. Inside is a letter, written in the lady's graceful yet strong script. (Give the players the letter handout in this boxed set, repeated in the adjacent sidebar.)

Though Rupert's tale sounds strange, you know well that the world is full of such dark mysteries, especially far from Bree's warmth. If Lady Gilraen thinks it worth investigating, it is not to be ignored.

GILRAEN

The Player-heroes are not alone in their endeavours – Gilraen, the mother of Aragorn, has been sponsoring their exploits, providing support and advice. Aragorn is the current chieftain of the Rangers of the North, but he often travels abroad. In his absence, the captains of the Rangers seek the advice of Gilraen, knowing her to be a wise and prudent counsellor.

> Gilraen doesn't play an active role in this adventure, but should the Player-heroes continue their adventures in Middle-earth, they will certainly find her help to be beneficial. Gilraen is described in *The Lord of the Rings Roleplaying* core rules compendium (page 217).

ASKING QUESTIONS

The Player-heroes might consider questioning Rupert further to pinpoint the exact location of the Crowned Hill.

> The hunter is still shaken, but a successful DC 10 Charisma (Intimidation or Persuasion) check may encourage him to share further details (however, using Intimidation is a Misdeed worth 1 Shadow point — see the Rules booklet).

If they do so, Rupert organises a rough map on a table in the inn, using platters and mugs to represent landmarks and a trail of crumbs to outline their itinerary. Alternatively, the Player-heroes could rely on their own knowledge of the region.

- ♦ A successful DC 10 Intelligence (Old Lore) check identifies the hill as being located not far from a small Hill-folk settlement known as Cránn. The inhabitants are known to be reclusive but not hostile.
- ♦ Succeeding by 5 or more on the check yields additionally information that the Loremaster can glean from the adjacent sidebar titled *The Dark Hills of Rhudaur.*

GILRAEN'S LETTER

Dear Friends,

I hope this letter finds you in good spirits, for I write to you with a heart heavy with concern. Just days ago, I chanced upon the disturbing story of a hunter from Bree named Rupert, who returned from the North Downs. His tale left me deeply troubled, for he spoke of experiencing a profound dread, the feeling that an ancient shadow had awakened in the dark hills.

As I pondered his account, my thoughts turned to you – valiant friends whose courage I greatly esteem. I asked Rupert to find you and share his story, something he has done if you are reading these words. I fear that this dark presence may pose a grave threat not only to those who dwell near the Downs but possibly to all who call Eriador home. I urge you to travel north to seek the source of this malevolence before it stirs further unrest.

You possess the valour and wisdom needed to confront this darkness. May your path be guided by the light of hope, and may you return with the knowledge and courage to face whatever lurks in the hills.

With the deepest respect and heartfelt worry,
Gilraen

THE SHE-WOLF OF ANGMAR

On the hill, Rupert Rushlight sensed the presence of a formidable foe — an ancient and cunning Warg-queen named Garaf, who is the true antagonist of this tale. This she-wolf is revered by a group of Goblins that have recently invaded the land of the Hill-folk. Driven by fear, these Goblins serve their mistress and regularly attempt to appease her by offering sacrifices at the Crowned Hill.

Recently, they launched a brutal raid on the village of Cránn. Those villagers who escaped death were seized and taken north to the caves where the Goblins and their savage Queen dwell. The captives are to be sacrificed under the light of the first full moon, a grim offering to sate the hunger of the ancient she-wolf and secure her favour.

THE DARK HILLS OF RHUDAUR

Hill-men have inhabited the northernmost lands of Eriador since before the foundation of the North Kingdom, driven into the inhospitable hills and mountains of Rhudaur by the advancing Númenóreans. Their resentment and persecution first led them to form an alliance with Angmar, which eventually turned into servitude.

Upon the defeat of the Witch-king, many who once served him fled east across the Misty Mountains. However, some chose to remain in the cold wastes of Rhudaur and Angmar, hiding in caves and secret valleys to evade the vengeful armies of Gondor and the High Elves.

With the passage of many centuries, their descendants still endure, living as hunters and warriors in a fragile peace with the Orcs that occasionally raid this region.

Into the North Downs

Prompted by the words of Rupert and the request of Lady Gilraen, the Player-heroes set out north, to reach the hill described by the hunter. The days are warm, and the night sky is clear.

Following the rules for Journeys presented in the Rules booklet, all Player-heroes must now choose a role from among Guide, Hunter, Look-out, and Scout. Then, the Loremaster should guide the players through a Journey sequence as follows:

1. **Set Journey Path.** For this introductory adventure, the path is set — refer to the map on page 4. To reach their destination, the Company will take the Greenway north towards Fornost for about 60 miles (three hexes on a road in Wild Lands), then head northeast into the North Downs for about the same distance (three hexes on open terrain in Dark Lands).
2. **Make Wisdom (Travel) Checks.** It's the month of September, and summer is still ongoing. The travelling Company will probably require one to three Wisdom (Travel) checks to cover the distance. This should cause them to face one or two Journey events.
3. **End the Journey.** The journey ends upon reaching the Crowned Hill, after approximately a week of travelling. All Player-heroes must deal with any accumulated Exhaustion.

EXPANDED JOURNEY EVENT: THE POOL OF THE DEAD MEN

When resolving Journey events, the Loremaster should be ready to improvise a short scene describing what is happening to the Company. The following description can be used to expand upon most event types, but is particularly suited for occurrences of *Terrible Misfortune*, *Despair*, or *Ill Choices*.

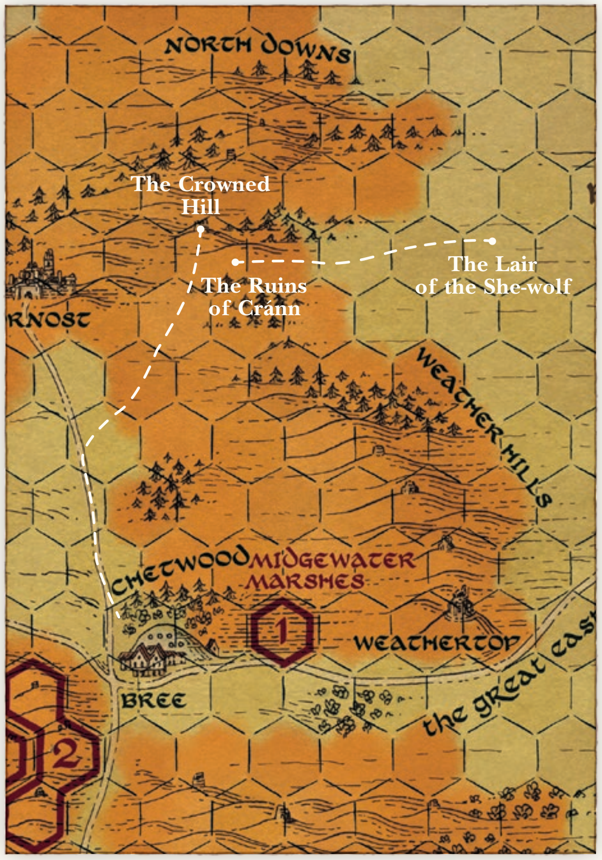
The day's journey comes to a close as the sun sinks below the hills. The sound of flowing water guides you to a small, grey pool, fed by a spring running among the rocks. This refreshing sight is a rare find in the barren landscape, making it seem like an ideal campsite.

The pool is haunted, for long ago, archers of Cardolan ambushed and slew soldiers from Angmar as they gathered water here. It was a merciless bloodbath, and the memory of this act lingers like a dark cloud over the site.

Drinking from the water is refreshing. However, approaching the water's surface is perilous: one of the drinkers notices an old brooch glittering just within arm's reach at the bottom of the pool, and touching it triggers a terrible curse.

> If the ability check required to resolve the event fails, an unseen force attempts to pull the Player-hero's head underwater, trying to drown them! In addition to the event type's usual consequences, the target loses d6 Hit Points due to partial suffocation.

Once the curse is triggered, the water of the pool clears, revealing bones and fragments of corroded armour visible on the bottom, hidden among the rocks.



NO REST FOR THE WEARY

As seen on page 22 of the Rules booklet, at the end of a journey each Player-hero must make a Fatigue saving throw to determine how many Exhaustion levels they accumulate. This occurs once the Company reaches their destination, the Crowned Hill, and again at the end of the second leg of their journey, when they reach the Lair of the She-wolf (see *Part 3* on page 8).

Unfortunately for the players, any Exhaustion levels left after the first Fatigue saving throw will carry over the following leg of the trip, as the Player-heroes won't be able to rest appropriately until the adventure is over.

Michael Sykett (Order #53484556)

PART 2:

THE CROWNED HILL

You have been following a tortuous path across the North Downs for some time when you finally see it. The hill that Rupert spoke of rises within a small wood, its summit mostly barren. The ascent is easy, and you quickly reach the top. Sparse grass patches cling to the rocky soil, where five grim, shadowy stones jut upward like the fingers of a skeletal hand. Four of these stones group together, their foreboding shapes mirrored by a solitary, thicker, yet shorter stone standing on the opposite side.

A terrible reek hangs in the air, emanating from a shallow pit dug in the middle of the ring of stones. As you look inside the pit, you discover the source of the vile stench: a large, decaying carcass swarmed by flies.

The ring of stones, a place of worship for the Hill-folk of Rhudaur, has been defiled by the Orcs and used to offer sacrifices to their mistress, Garaf, the Warg-queen. The place is now cursed, tainted by the evil acts that have occurred within it. Show the players the map image below.

> Player-heroes climbing the Crowned Hill to its top and entering the ring of stones gain 2 Shadow points, resisted by a DC 15 Charisma saving throw. Those who fail their saving throw experience the same unnatural cold felt by Rupert Rushlight, and perceive an ominous presence watching them from afar.

THE CURSED PIT

The carcass in the pit, savagely slain and partially devoured by some kind of beast, clearly belongs to a large horse. Examining the remains of the unfortunate animal (potentially supported by appropriate rolls) may reveal the following information:

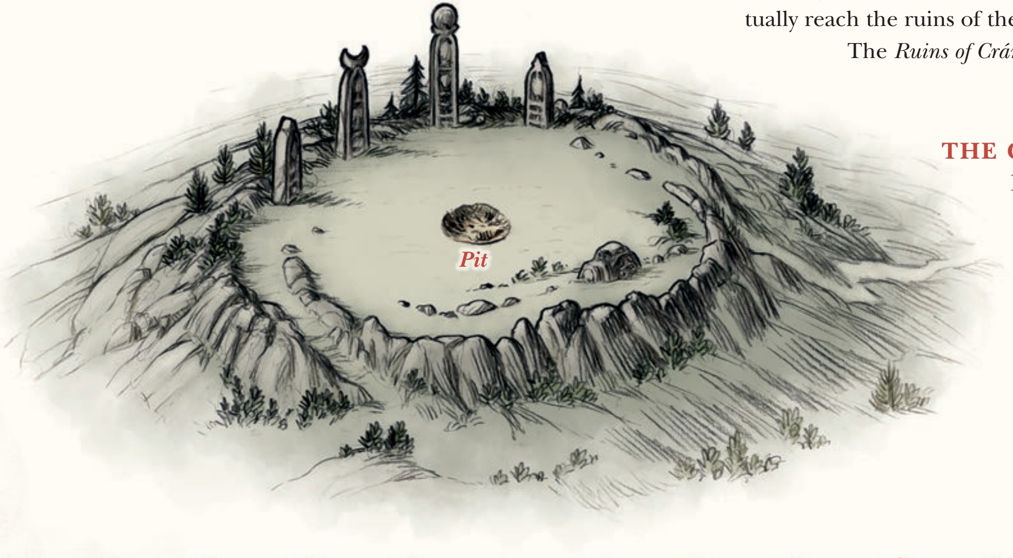
- Half-burnt remains of the mount's bridle may be recognized by an Elven or Ranger Player-hero as having once belonged to one of the Dúnedain (the same information may be obtained with a successful DC 10 Intelligence (Investigation) check).
- A successful DC 10 Wisdom (Hunting) check reveals that the beast was killed within the last three days. Other burnt bones suggest that this grim site has witnessed many more grisly offerings, including the remains of large animals like boars and deer, as well as human and Orcish bones.

If the Player-heroes decide to stop to give the horse a proper burial, it will surely be a thing its owner will consider well.

HINTS AND RIDDLES

Additional information can be gathered at the site as follows:

- Tracks on the top of the hill can be examined with a DC 10 Wisdom (Hunting) check, revealing evidence of multiple Goblins and a pack of four-legged animals, most likely Wargs. Succeeding by 5 or more uncovers a massive paw print, indicating that one of the creatures was of enormous size.
- If the Player-heroes examine the stones, they discover ancient, inscrutable runes written in the language of the Hill-folk. The inscriptions have recently been defiled with unsettling scrawls and foul symbols. A successful DC 10 Intelligence (Old Lore) check reveals that these markings are an invocation in a debased dialect of the Common Tongue used by Orcs, praising 'the mighty Queen of the Night, the Fang of the North.'
- An ancient path leads eastward from the Crowned Hill. If the Player-heroes choose to follow it, they will eventually reach the ruins of the village of Cránn (see The *Ruins of Cránn* on page 6).



THE CROWNED HILL

The Attack

A small band of Goblins lingers in the woods surrounding the Crowned Hill, having noticed the Company's approach. Led by the shrewd Orc hunter Hakmogg, the Goblins are clad in wolf furs, wearing helms that resemble wolf heads, and they carry shields crudely painted with wolf shapes.

- There are half as many **Goblin Archers** as there are Player-heroes in the Company (rounded up). **Hakmogg** is accompanied by a **Wild Wolf**, the offspring of Garaf.

Hakmogg is a hardened veteran. As he spots the Company approaching, he watches them intently from a distance, biding his time for the perfect moment to strike (always when the sun is covered, or at night). That ideal opportunity may come when the Player-heroes are preoccupied with examining the summit of the Crowned Hill.

> The attack occurs at Short range, allowing just a single opening volley. Allow the Player-heroes a DC 10 Wisdom (Perception) check to spot the attackers. If it fails, the Goblins attack first in the opening volley.

Play out the combat using the combat diagram and the cardboard stand-up figures included in this boxed set, and the combat sequence outlined on page 12 in the Rules booklet. If Hakmogg is slain, the Wild Wolf and any remaining Goblins flee.

The Ruins of Cránn

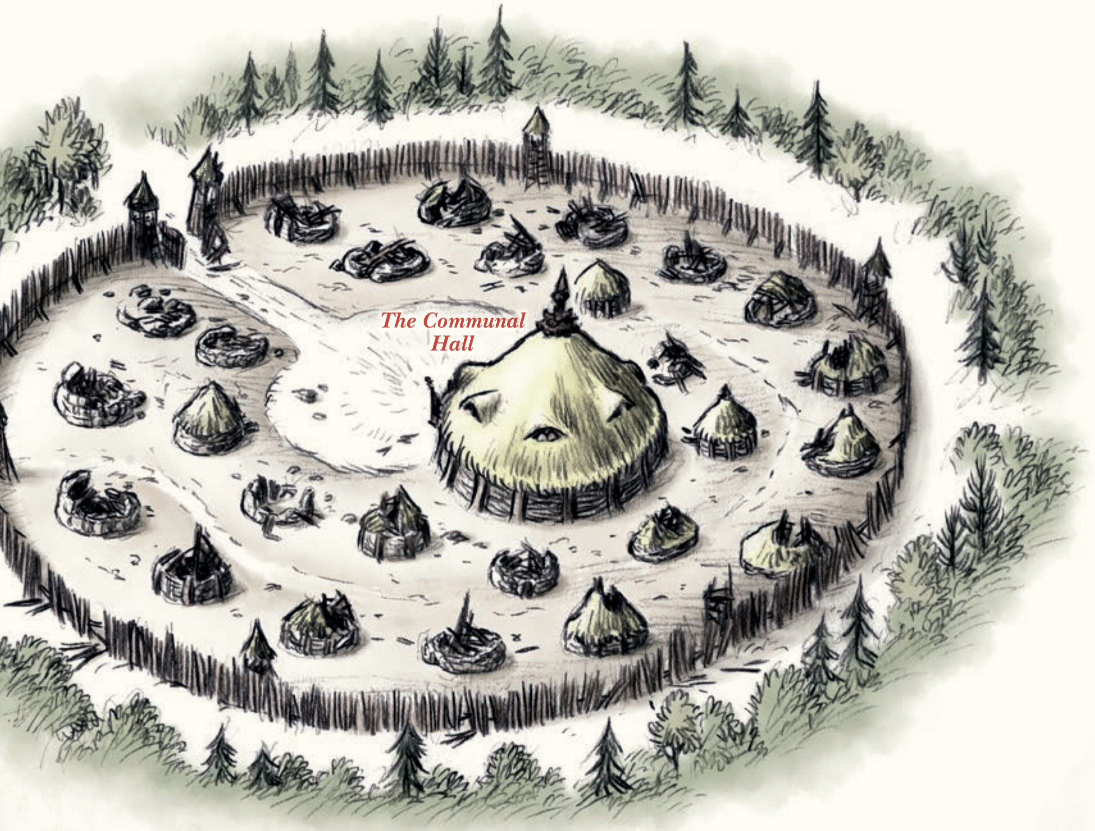
The Player-heroes reach Cránn by following the eastward path from the Crowned Hill. No Journey procedure is needed, as the locations are just a few miles apart (in the same hex). Upon arrival, however, an unsettling scene awaits them.

Emerging from the woods, you first catch sight of what appears to be an unusual thicket, its dense growth seeming unnatural. However, upon closer inspection, it becomes evident that it's actually a palisade made of tightly packed tree trunks, their branches largely, but not completely, hacked off. There is no immediately visible opening in the fence. The silence is striking: no barking dogs, no bleating sheep, and no smoke rising from chimneys to greet you.

Show the players the map image below. The entrance to the village is located to the north, where a once-sturdy timber gate now lies shattered on the ground. Inside, the aftermath of a recent and brutal attack is unmistakable. About two dozen huts are in ruins, with most of their structures demolished and clear evidence of a fierce struggle. Remarkably, few bodies are left behind, but those that are have been half-devoured by Wargs, now serving as grisly offerings for the crows.

Amidst the wreckage, one structure stands out due to its size — the Communal Hall.

THE RUINS OF CRÁNN



THE COMMUNAL HALL

The largest structure of the village is a circular building spanning a dozen paces across and standing half as tall. It likely served as the main gathering place for the people of Cránn. Its thatched roof is supported by large, carved wooden beams, their surfaces adorned with symbols from times long past. The hall's door lies shattered, and the sparse furniture has been demolished, evidence of a violent skirmish still visible. The only intact fixture is a large stone fireplace, cold and dark but untouched by the destruction.

If the Player-heroes wish, the Communal Hall provides a safe enough shelter to rest for the night. Yet, it isn't as empty as it appears. Concealed among the rafters are half a dozen children of the Hill-folk: **Cuvrag**, a 9-year-old survivor of the slaughter, and his five younger siblings. From their perch, they silently observe the Company, careful not to reveal their presence.

The children are terrified and very stealthy — the Player-heroes have a chance to notice their presence if they set up a watch at night or if they set up camp in the Communal Hall. In particular, the children grow anxious if the Player-heroes start to cook something — the enticing aroma of food wafts through the air, provoking the half-starved children to shift around, unable to contain their hunger.

MEET THE CHILDREN

To gain the children's trust and encourage them to reveal what happened to their village, the Company must first coax them from their hiding spot, earning their confidence with the right approach. The interaction can be played out using the rules for Councils (page 18 in the Rules booklet).

1. First, set the required number of successes based on what the Company intends to ask the children:
   - Asking them to recount the village attack from their perch on the beams is a reasonable request (1 success required).
   - Encouraging them to come down and speak face-to-face is a bold request (2 successes required).
   - Persuading them to send one of them (Cuvrag) to guide the Company and point them in the right direction is an outrageous request (3 successes required), though this is reduced to a bold request (2 successes) if the Company pledges to save their kin.
2. Then, the spokesperson must introduce the Company and their intentions with a DC 15 Charisma check. The skill proficiencies that can be used and the consequences of the check are detailed on page 19 of the Rules booklet.
3. The children's deep-rooted suspicion of outsiders requires the interaction to be handled with care. Charisma (Persuasion) is a good choice to lead the conversation, as is Charisma (Performance). The children's attitude is Open (DC 15). However, they are reluctant to speak if approached by an Elf or a Ranger, whom they find intimidating: the DC of the checks made by such Player-heroes is 20. On the contrary, if the conversation is led by a Hobbit, the children are more at ease and the ability checks have DC 10.

Cuvrag

Cuvrag, though only nine summers old, is considered nearly a man by the standards of the Hill-folk. He has been protecting his younger siblings since their parents sickened and died when an ill wind came from the north two years prior. They often hid in the rafters of the Communal Hall to play, and this time their game saved their lives. The night of the attack Cuvrag overheard a Goblin muttering nervously, 'They will appease her ever-hungry maws. I won't be her next meal.'

If the Council is successful, Cuvrag takes upon himself the responsibility to share the grim details: two days ago, Goblins dressed in wolf pelts, accompanied by fierce Wargs, launched a night raid on the village. The air was filled with the dreadful howls of both creatures. After subduing the villagers, the attackers chained them together and led them east.

When asked about the Crowned Hill and its cursed pit, Cuvrag explains that it is a place the Hill-folk now dread and avoid, as rumours persist that it is haunted by darkness. Recently, a village hunter claimed to have seen an enormous Warg's paw print near it. Over the past year, Cuvrag adds, the game in the region has dwindled sharply, as though some insatiable predator has been devouring it all.

THE TRAIL LEADS EAST

The tracks left by the attackers are unmistakable, etched into the earth around Cránn like scars. Even a cursory inspection reveals signs of a large group: scores of individuals, a mix of Goblins, Men, and the clawed prints of a large Warg pack, all travelling east.

The direction of the trail sends an icy dread through the Company, as it leads deep into the lone-lands of Rhudaur — a dark, accursed kingdom, home to evil spirits and wild Men.

LEVELLING UP

After Part 2 of this adventure is concluded, each Player-hero automatically advances to level 2, gaining more Hit Points and gaining new features and virtues. This is explained on page 4 in the Rules booklet.

PART 3:

IRON JAWS

Following the path marked by the tracks of both captors and captives, the Company ventures deep into the desolate wild lands of Rhudaur.

Once again, the Player-heroes must choose their roles for the Journey and play it out using the sequence presented on page 21 in the Rules booklet. This Journey leads straight east for about 80 miles (four hexes) through open terrain in Wild Lands (see the map on page 4).

If the Player-heroes persuaded the children of Cránn to let Cuvrag guide them, his local knowledge allows the Guide of the Company to gain Advantage on the first Wisdom (Travel) check. The boy leaves the Company to return to his duties after that.

> Any event on this Journey should be expanded upon to play the scene *The Grim Pursuer* (below). The type of event rolled should affect how this scene is presented. In fact, this scene should be played out even if the Journey is covered by a single Wisdom (Travel) check.

The journey ends upon reaching the Lair of the She-wolf. All Player-heroes must deal with any accumulated levels of Exhaustion.

THE GRIM PURSUER

As the Player-heroes follow the tracks left by the Goblins, they are unaware that someone is tracking them in turn. The Company's Lookout can attempt a DC 14 Wisdom (Perception) check to detect a solitary figure cloaked in tattered garments, resembling a spectre haunting this forsaken land.

This elusive figure is exceptionally difficult to shake off, and the Company will eventually need to confront him, preferably as part of a Journey event (page 3). Depending on their strategy, they might set an ambush, find a defensible spot to await his approach, or even choose to greet him openly around the campfire.

This mysterious figure means no harm — he follows for a reason. Read or play out the following:

The mysterious wanderer lowers his hood, revealing a tall, lean Ranger with shaggy dark hair and piercing grey eyes, untouched by time. Despite his youthful appearance, his face reflects a depth of wisdom beyond his years. 'I come in peace,' he says. 'I have been searching for a stolen horse in the Lone-lands, and found what remained of it in a pit atop the Crowned Hill. The tracks led me to you. You don't look like horse killers to me, so I wonder what you are doing in these savage lands.'

> The Ranger initially withholds his name, carefully observing the Player-heroes. Eventually, he introduces himself as 'Strider.' Residents of Bree have heard of him from occasional visits to *the Prancing Pony*, while Elves of Rivendell and other Rangers may have some insight into his true identity as Aragorn, son of Arathorn and Gilraen the Fair.

Strider tells how he was returning to Bree with other Rangers when they were ambushed by Goblins, who managed to steal a horse amid the chaos and flee north. If the Company has treated the fallen animal with respect, Aragorn expresses his gratitude before asking about their mission and identities. As the son of Gilraen, the Company's Patron, he has some knowledge of them but prefers to be certain. Caution is wise in these parts, where deception is common.

Upon learning more about their business, Strider mentions that he has heard tales of a new Goblin clan in the area with unusual customs, although he has not yet had the opportunity to investigate further.

Aragorn will not offer to join the Company on their mission, as he has other pressing matters to attend to, far away to the South. However, if one or more Player-heroes are seriously injured, Aragorn will offer them a drink from a silver-bound flask containing Miruvor, the cordial of Imladris.

> Those who partake in it recover all lost Hit Points and cancel one level of Exhaustion.

THE LAIR OF THE SHE-WOLF

As the journey approaches its conclusion, the Loremaster should read or paraphrase the following:

Your hunt has taken you deep into the forgotten realm of Rhudaur. As you advance toward the Misty Mountains, the peak of Mount Gram looms ever closer, its malevolent presence sending a chill down your spine. Eventually, the Goblin tracks deviate from their eastward path, winding down a dark, narrow valley.

Upon reaching its end, you find yourself confronted by a dreary, rocky mound that resembles a heap of gigantic stones carelessly piled by a bored giant. At its summit you catch glimpses of ancient walls

Michael Sweett (Order #53484556)

of stones, and the ruins of towers with an evil look, as if they had been built by wicked people.

At the base of the mound lies a gaping cave entrance, its interior shrouded in impenetrable darkness. Gather your courage, for it appears you are about to put your mettle to the test.

The mouth of the cave is scattered with old bones — both human and animal — the remnants of sacrifices made by the Goblins to appease their mistress, Garaf. The bones, broken by enormous, powerful jaws, clearly indicate they were shattered by a formidable beast.

The entrance leads into a vast cavern, from which several dark passages extend deeper underground. When Garaf accepted the Goblins as her servants, she permitted them to inhabit the outer caverns, reserving the deeper, darker caves for herself and her pack. She emerges only to hunt or to receive worship from the Orcs.

MANY PATHS

The cave system beneath the hills sprawls for miles, forming a vast, intricate maze. Inside, darkness reigns, so it is assumed that the Player-heroes carry lanterns, torches, or other sources of light.

> The exploration of this underground complex requires three DC 15 Wisdom (Explore) checks, each conducted individually by a Player-hero chosen to act as the guide.

The checks can have the following results:

- **Failure:** the Company must face a *dangerous encounter.* Roll a d6 on the table for dangerous encounters.
- **Success:** the Company must face a *normal encounter.* Roll a d6 on the table for normal encounters.
- **Success by 5 or more:** the guide is starting to make sense of this maze — no encounter!

Reroll if an encounter already passed is rolled again. Once all three rolls have been performed and the encounters resolved, the Company reaches the Goblin Lair.

> If at least one of the Wisdom (Explore) checks succeeded by 5 or more, the Player-heroes reach it by the High-Level Tunnel. Otherwise, they arrive by the Main Entrance. See page 12.

NORMAL ENCOUNTERS

HOWLS FROM THE DEEP

A chilling howl reverberates through the caverns, echoing off the walls and reaching the Company with unsettling clarity. It sounds ancient and savage — something that no one would wish to encounter.

The howl comes from Garaf, disturbed in her lair by the presence of intruders. Each Player-hero gains 1 Shadow Point, resisted by a DC 15 Charisma saving throw. The sound emanates from the deeper tunnels — should the Company choose to pursue it, they gain Advantage on their next Wisdom (Explore) check.

DRUMS IN THE DARKNESS

The sound of drums and the savage chants of the Goblins echo through the caverns. You must be nearing the lair of the Orcs.

If the Company decides to follow the drumming, they gain Advantage on their next Wisdom (Explore) check. However, the repeated beat indicates that the Goblins are assembling. If the encounter occurs, 2 more **Goblin Archers** will be present at the Goblin Lair (page 12).

NORMAL ENCOUNTERS

d6	ENCOUNTER
1	Howls From the Deep
2–3	Drums In the Darkness
4–5	Orcish Roast
6	The Petrified Troll

DANGEROUS ENCOUNTERS

d6	ENCOUNTER
1	Watching Eyes of The Queen
2–3	Bridge of Perils
4–5	Banquet of Blood
6	The Secret Armoury

ORCISH ROAST

The damp smell of the caverns gives way to the odour of burning wood. Around a bend, flickering firelight and guttural voices fill the air.

If the Company investigates, the voices become clearer:

'I told you, Kishak, we should cut her up and fry her in the pan!'

'You are dumb as a stone, Jagga! You roast her on a spit until she's blackened!'

Peering in, the Company sees two large **Orc Guards**, Kishak and Jagga, arguing around a fire as they debate how to cook their prisoner. A nearby sack reveals a pair of feet in wooden clogs — belonging to **Vella**, a Hill-folk woman from Cránn, who has been smuggled away by the Orcs for their own gruesome plans. The Orcs are distracted, allowing the Player-heroes to attempt a surprise attack, create a distraction, or even make a DC 10 Charisma (Deception) check to imitate their voices, potentially inciting them to fight each other.

If the Company rescues Vella, they gain valuable information (see the adjacent sidebar). Choosing to leave her counts as a Misdeed, granting 2 Shadow Points to each Player-hero. Inform them of this if they seem to have this intent.

Vella

Vella, a Hill-folk villager, is in her late twenties. Unmarried and content, her only love was her flock of hens, which she tended with motherly care. During the raid, the Goblins devoured her beloved chickens, and her fury towards them burns hotter than her grief for her home or village. She knows the general layout of the Goblin Lair, having been forced along the brutal march to the caves, but her knowledge of the caverns is limited, as the two Orc gluttons bagged her head and carried her away.

THE PETRIFIED TROLL

A single ray of sunlight shines through a crack in the ceiling of the cavern, casting an eerie light across an enormous stone figure — a Troll, wearing a helm with a broken horn, frozen in mid-motion, hand raised as if examining something delicate between his fingers. The cavern feels as still as a painting.

This petrified Troll is Guzar Half-horn, an infamous robber who terrorised the kingdom of Arthedain centuries ago. Recognizable by the broken horn of his helm, the monster appears in several old ballads, allowing the Company to identify him with a DC 10 Intelligence (Old Lore) check. According to the stories, hunted by the King's men, Guzar fled to Rhudaur to hide with his stolen loot, and his tracks were lost there. Unfortunately for him, the monster took refuge in a cavern where sunlight streamed in through a crack in the ceiling, turning him to stone.

An inspection of the statue reveals a golden ring on his finger — the only item unaffected by the petrification. To reach it, a Player-hero must climb the massive stone figure with a DC 10 Strength (Athletics) check. If they fail, the statue collapses and shatters. The climber and anyone nearby lose d6 Hit Points.

The ring, a powerful artefact called the Band of Greystock (see the adjacent sidebar), is worth the risk.

THE BAND OF GREYSTOCK

This simple golden ring features a rare grey hematite stone and traces its origins to the lost kingdom of Númenor. It passed through generations of healers, whose descendants settled in Tharbad, eventually simplifying their name to 'Stock.' The ring's last owner was Tarion Stock, healer to the King of Arthedain, before he vanished during a journey. Lady Almarian Stock of Tharbad (see the expansion *Ruins of Eriador*, page 15) is the last living heir of the family and would greatly value its return.

- **The wearer of the Band of Greystock can choose to succeed automatically on an Intelligence (Medicine) check as if they had rolled a ᚠ. Once they do so, they can't do so again until they finish a Long Rest. When pressed against a poisoned or infected wound, the hematite gem turns red, purging impurities and draining the bad blood.**

DANGEROUS ENCOUNTERS

WATCHING EYES OF THE QUEEN

You enter cautiously into a vast cavern filled with jagged stalactites and stalagmites, but come to an abrupt halt. At the centre looms an enormous black Warg, as large as a wagon, crouched and poised as if ready to strike. Its malevolent gaze seems to burn straight into you.

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Luckily, the 'Warg' is no living beast. It's a strange rock formation, eerily shaped like a large, crouched wolf. Goblins, noticing the uncanny resemblance, made subtle carvings on the stone to heighten the likeness. They even hollowed eye sockets into the 'head' of the figure and filled them with yellow crystals, creating the unsettling illusion of bright, watchful eyes.

- An air of malice emanates from the rock, a feeling that the Player-heroes can perceive from a distance. Those who draw close and meet the gaze of its sinister eyes gain 2 Shadow Points, resisted by a DC 15 Intelligence saving throw. If they attempt to sneak around it, they may make a DC 15 Dexterity (Stealth) check. If they fail, they will cross the statue's baleful stare, resulting in the same effect.
- Should the Company attempt to 'blind' the statue by tearing out the stones from its sockets, they must first make a DC 15 Charisma saving throw. A failure means they have confronted the statue's stare, with the same consequences as above. On a success, a strange sense of triumph washes over them, as if they have weakened Garaf's influence in this dark place. The Loremaster should note that Garaf's Hit Points are reduced by 10.

BRIDGE OF PERILS

The passageway opens onto the edge of a deep chasm, from which the sound of rushing water echoes upward. A narrow, frayed rope bridge stretches across, supported by two ropes tied to either side. At the far end, two Orc Soldiers stand idly guarding the bridge, engrossed in a low, guttural conversation.

The Player-heroes can attempt to ambush the **Orc Soldiers**. If both are not eliminated right away, one of them will try to sever the ropes supporting the bridge, cutting one rope each round. Once the first rope is severed, anyone on the bridge must make a DC 15 Strength (Athletics) check to avoid falling. If both ropes are severed, the bridge will collapse.

If a Player-hero falls into the underground river, they lose 2d6 Hit Points. Then, they can climb back up.

Alternatively, the heroes can bypass the bridge by navigating a narrow ledge along the chasm's edge, which can be spotted with a DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check. Walking this precarious path requires a DC 10 Dexterity (Acrobatics) check — failure results in a fall, with the same consequences as above.

BANQUET OF BLOOD

A low growl echoes through the passage, accompanied by the sickening sound of gnawing jaws. In the dim light, yellow eyes glint — first one pair, then another, and another…

A pack of **Wild Wolves** is feasting on the remains of an unfortunate Goblin, their leader growling in a raspy voice, *'Who dares disturb our snack?'* The Wild Wolves are one fewer than the Player-heroes, but all ready to abandon their meal to attack!

If the Company engages the ravenous monsters and prevails, they discover that the Goblin is severely wounded but still alive. His name is Kulash, and, though weak, he remains defiant, smirking as the Company approaches: *'Ha! You think you've saved me? I'd rather be a meal than be rescued by a bunch of bumbling fools like you!'*

The Player-heroes have the opportunity to interrogate Kulash for more information about the Wargs and the surrounding area. Kulash reveals that the Wild Wolves consider the Goblins little more than slaves to their mighty queen, Garaf, and that when they are nervous or hungry, they feel no guilt in devouring one or two.

If the Company spares or aids him, Kulash begrudgingly provides directions to the Goblin Lair, granting them an automatic success (as if rolled with a ᚠ) on their next Wisdom (Explore) check.

THE SECRET ARMOURY

Pausing in the dim passage to catch your breath, you ponder whether to press on or turn back when something peculiar catches your eye: the torch flame flickers, drawn towards a section of the cavern wall as if stirred by a draft.

The Company must make a DC 10 Wisdom (Perception) check. If everyone fails, the encounter ends here. However, if at least one Player-hero succeeds, they notice a secret door, artfully concealed. It lacks a handle or keyhole but opens with a precise press in just the right spot. A successful DC 10 Dexterity (Sleight of Hand) check is required to access it.

The door leads to a square chamber hewn from solid rock, clearly unnatural in its precision. Dust-laden racks of weapons, quivers of arrows, and shields bearing the seal of Angmar line the walls. This is an armoury dating back from the days of the dreaded Witch-king.

Closer inspection reveals that the array of scimitars, spears, short bows, and shields does not compare favourably to the quality of the war gear already carried by the Player-heroes. However, in the far corner lies an unexpected find: a sealed barrel with a short length of rope dangling from the top.

> A successful DC 10 Intelligence (Old Lore) check reveals this to be a rare and dangerous item — a barrel of Orcish blasting fire, a devilish device favoured by Goblins and Orcs (see sidebar on page 12).

ORCISH BLASTING FIRE

This sinister mixture of powders, coal, and minerals showcases the devious cunning of Orcs. It is a preparation used to create violent explosions capable of shattering walls or forcing open stone passages. Extremely dangerous to handle, many Orcs often fall victim to their own audacity when using it. The Company may choose to bring the barrel along, turning the Enemy's own malice back against them.

- The barrel, pre-set with a fuse, requires a DC 10 Dexterity (Sleight of Hand) check to ignite. On a success, the Player-heroes can set up the device and retreat to a safe distance. If the check fails, the ancient fuse fizzles out and does not ignite. If the check fails with an 👁 result, the fuse ignites in a flash, engulfing the Company in the blast as they attempt to escape.
- For each victim of the Orcish blasting fire, roll a d10 to see how many Hit Points they lose. If set against a wall or door, the blasting fire is sure to create a passage through any barrier except the thickest ones.
- The barrel is unwieldy to carry (it weighs 20 pound) and can be used only once. As a product of dark arts, employing it is a Misdeed worth 1 Shadow Point.

BRAVING THE GOBLIN LAIR

The final part of the adventure can pose a significant challenge for inexperienced players. A direct assault will likely be quite difficult, so the Loremaster should encourage the players to think creatively — just as Gandalf relied on cunning to outwit the Goblins of the Misty Mountains. Here are some suggested strategies:

- **High-level Tunnel:** Entering the lair from here allows the Company to scout the area and gain the element of surprise.
- **Focus on the Prisoners:** The primary goal is freeing the captives. Some Player-heroes may create a diversion (e.g., setting the huts on fire) while others handle the rescue.
- **Choose the Battlefield:** Fighting on the Company's terms is key. Climbing the Stone Column can offer an excellent vantage point for archers to thin the ranks of the enemy.
- **Orcish Blasting Fire:** If obtained, this powerful tool can create chaos, whether used as a bomb or a diversion. The prisoners in the trench are protected from the blast.
- **The Maws of the Queen:** A stealthy scout could bypass the village entirely, retrieve Araf's Bane from the Maws of the Queen, and face Garaf before the Orcs can react. Killing her would turn the tide of the battle, as the Orcs worship the she-wolf. They would be terrified of anyone deemed powerful enough to slay her.

THE GOBLIN LAIR

The flickering light of fires and the echo of guttural voices signal that you have at last reached the lair of the Goblins. The heavy stench that fills your nostrils confirms it.

In the heart of a vast cavern stands a towering stone column surrounded by a deep trench, used by the Goblins as a prison. Beyond the lair lies the entrance to the deeper, darker reaches of the caverns, a home only for Garaf and her Warg offspring.

> If at least one of the three Wisdom (Explore) checks while exploring the underground complex succeeded by 5 or more, the Player-heroes reach it by the High-Level Tunnel (#2). Otherwise, they arrive by the Main Entrance (#1).

Show the players the map image on page 13. The numbered locations on the map are further described below.

1. MAIN ENTRANCE

The main passage into the lair opens onto an elevated stone ledge. Roughly hewn steps descend from here into the cavern, leading directly into the Goblin encampment.

- The entrance is guarded by a **Goblin Archer** carrying a horn. If he detects any intruders and is not killed in the first round of combat, he sounds the alarm (page 14).

2. HIGH-LEVEL TUNNEL

This secondary passage has been neglected by the Orcs and ends roughly a dozen yards above the cavern floor.

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> The Player-heroes can reach ground level by climbing down a steep, broken escarpment, which requires a DC 10 Strength (Athletics) check for each Player-hero. If a check fails, they make enough noise to alert nearby Orcs who will raise the alarm. Climbing up from the bottom is inevitably noisy, unless aided by ropes or climbing gear from above.

3. PELT HUTS

Despite being underground, the Orcs have constructed crude huts from uncured skins, which fill the air with an unbearable stench. Each hut is similar, featuring a filthy pallet, stones for sharpening teeth and weapons, and half-eaten bones along with other repulsive items the Orcs value. In the southwestern part of the cavern, a communal fire serves as the tribe's gathering place.

- There are two groups of **Goblin Archers** and **Orc Soldiers** here. Each group has two Orc Soldiers, and Goblin Archers in equal number to the Player-heroes minus 1.

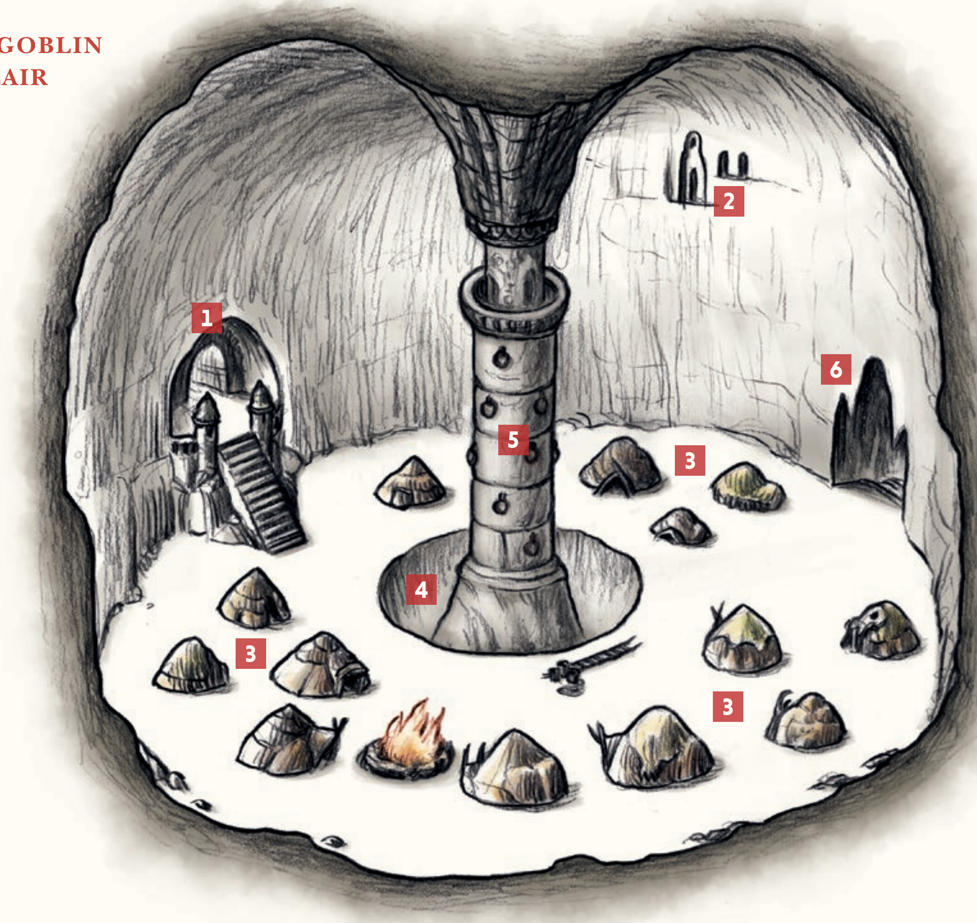
Each Player-hero who tries to sneak around among the Pelt Huts must make a DC 15 Dexterity (Stealth) check. If a check fails, the Orcs sound the alarm. One group will then attack immediately, with the second group joining the fray in the third round of combat.

4. PRISONERS' TRENCH

The prisoners — about a dozen villagers from Cránn, are held in a deep trench encircling the base of the central stone column. The trench is three yards deep with steep walls, making escape impossible without assistance from above. A rickety ladder lies near its edge, alongside buckets of slop used to feed the prisoners. The ladder can also serve as a makeshift bridge, spanning the trench to reach the stone column.

> Each Player-hero who tries to sneak to the trench to stage an escape for the prisoners must make a DC 10 Dexterity (Stealth) check. If a check fails, the Orcs sound the alarm as per above. If it succeeds, the Orcs will automatically be alerted once the prisoners start to climb out. They will then call for Garaf (page 14).

THE GOBLIN LAIR



ADVERSARIES

When the Player-heroes arrive, the number of Adversaries present in the Goblin Lair is as follows:

- One **Goblin Archer** at the Main Entrance (#1).
- Two groups of **Goblin Archers** and **Orc Soldiers** among the Pelt Huts (#3). Each group has two Orc Soldiers, and Goblin Archers in equal number to the Player-heroes minus 1 – so four Orcs and eight Goblins in total if all five Player-heroes as used.
- **Garaf, The Hound of Angmar,** in The Maws of The Queen (#6). If there are four Player-heroes in the Company, Garaf is accompanied by one Wild Wolf, and by two if there are five Player-heroes.

Raising the Alarm: The Adversaries are not expecting a fight, and the Player-heroes can move around the Goblin Lair unnoticed if they are careful. However, the alarm will be raised if any of the following occurs:

- The Goblin at the Main Entrance (#1) spots the Player-heroes and is not killed in the first round of combat.
- The Player-heroes try to reach the Prisoners' Trench (#4) but fail a Dexterity (Stealth) check.
- The Player-heroes sneak around among the Pelt Huts (#3) but fail a Dexterity (Stealth) check.
- A Player-hero fails a DC 10 Strength (Athletics) check while climbing down from the High-Level Tunnel (#2).
- The Orcish blasting fire (page 12) ignites.
- Any other loud noise caused by the Player-heroes.

If the alarm is raised, the Goblins and Orcs among the Pelt Huts will attack the intruders. The fight starts at Short range. However, only one group will attack immediately, with the second group joining the fray in the third round of combat.

Summoning Garaf: The true danger lurking within these caverns is not the Orcs and Goblins, but their dreadful mistress, Garaf. This enormous Warg will appear if summoned by the Orcs, who will cease fighting and raise a collective, bone-chilling howl for an entire round. The Orcs will do this in two instances:

- They have suffered casualties amounting to half or more of their number.
- The Company is about to free the prisoners and is attempting an escape.

Right after the howl, all remaining Orcs and Goblins flee. Before all of the prisoners have left the Prisoners' Trench (#4), **Garaf** arrives – a massive she-wolf (possibly flanked by one or two **Wild Wolves**). See page 15 for more information.

5. THE STONE COLUMN

This wide stone pillar supports the cavern's vaulted ceiling. If it were destroyed — say, with Orcish blasting fire (page 12) — the ceiling would collapse, obliterating everything within. It would be wise to ensure a safe distance from the cavern before attempting this.

> The column has numerous handholds, making it easy to climb. From a small ledge near the top, a Player-hero gains an excellent vantage point over the entire cavern. From here, they can adopt a Rearward Stance, raining arrows down upon enemies regardless of the Company's size, and attack rolls from here have Advantage.

6. THE MAWS OF THE QUEEN

On the far side of the cavern, a large, ominous opening leads down into the depths of Garaf's territory. The entrance is ringed with sharp stalactites and stalagmites. Wargs, and occasionally Garaf herself, emerge from this passage. The Orcs fear this area and refuse to enter it for any reason.

If the Player-heroes dare to cross the threshold, they will find two openings to the left and right of the passage that lead to two identical chambers. Beyond these dark openings, the path continues deeper into the bowels of the earth.

The chamber to the left serves as the lair of Garaf, the last surviving Hound of Angmar. The chamber to the right is occupied by the bones of another massive Warg — what remains of Araf, the male twin of the She-wolf of Rhudaur (page 15). Embedded deeply into the thick skull of the fallen Warg is an Elven Great Spear, Araf's Bane (see the adjacent sidebar).

> Garaf does not expect any enemy to challenge her in her lair and never sets a watch. Yet, even in deep slumber, she can readily detect the approach of any Elf or Ranger by their scent.

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NAURNAITH, ARAF'S BANE

Forged in Eregion for the war against Sauron, its blade is etched with leaves and flowers of aconite and bound with ancient Elven runes.

- Naurnaith is a Great Spear bound with spells for the Bane of Wolves. The spear scores a Critical Hit on a roll of 19 or ᚠ on the d20, and also on an 18 if used against Wolves.

GARAF, THE FANG OF THE NORTH

When **Garaf** is summoned by the Orcs, read or paraphrase the following:

From the shadows steps forth a creature you might have thought could only exist in nightmares. She stands as tall as a horse, though far more savage. Her fur is ashen grey, like a death shroud, and a pale yellow light glows bright in her one good eye, the other dimmed by a scar from a long-forgotten battle. Her lips curl back in a snarl, revealing fangs as long as daggers, frothing with rancid foam.

In a voice that is both raspy and chillingly clear, she speaks: "Who dares tread into my den and threaten my servants?"

Whether the Company answers or remains silent, Garaf's reply is the same:

"My teeth have crushed the bones of princes of Arthedain and I devoured the flesh of Elven warriors. I will feast upon your bodies while they are yet warm! For I am Garaf, the first hound of the Witch-king, the Fang of the North, and men scatter like leaves in my presence!"

With that, she lunges (along with any accompanying **Wild Wolves**, see the previous page). Garaf fights with ferocity and cunning. She has survived as long as she has because she is no fool. If reduced to 20 Hit Points or less, she will attempt to retreat into the deep shadows of her lair. If she survives and recovers, she will recognize the Company's scent and, from then on, lead a relentless pack to hunt them down.

If the Company manages to defeat Garaf, any remaining Wargs flee, terrified by the loss of their queen.

Garaf, the Hound of Angmar

Garaf is one of two great wolves that once served the Witch-king during the wars of Angmar. Her bloodline stretches back to Carcharoth, the dread wolf who once guarded Angband. On the battlefield, Garaf and her twin, Araf, struck terror into the armies of Arthedain, leading the vanguard of the Wargs.

At the Battle of Fornost, Araf was mortally wounded while intercepting a spear cast by Haligrel, a noble of Glorfindel's Elven host. This act saved the Lord of Angmar, allowing him to escape. Mad with rage at her brother's loss, Garaf turned upon Haligrel and ripped the life from him. She then fled the field, gravely wounded, carrying the carcass of her twin.

For centuries, Garaf hid in the deep caverns of Rhudaur, feeling that her Master had abandoned her and his kingdom. Years later, a tribe of Goblins found her and pledged their loyalty to her. Now, with a host of followers, Garaf begins to sense the distant call of her old Master once more, and thoughts of darkness stir within her.

EPILOGUE

After the final battle, read or paraphrase the following text:

Your steps carry you away from the dark hills of Rhudaur, and as you return to the Bree-land, you feel the weight on your spirit lighten. You have braved great perils and faced dire enemies, emerging victorious. Yet, a lingering sense remains that your journey is far from over. These trials were merely the beginning; the Shadow stirs, awaiting your return to its path.

But such thoughts are not for today. Today, the sun warmly caresses your skin, and the birds fill the air with their song. You yearn for rest — a warm bed, a hearty meal, and a tankard of ale shared with fellow patrons at the Prancing Pony.

If the Player-heroes have vanquished or evaded Garaf, freed the prisoners, and led them safely back to their village, they can now return to the quiet of their homes. Should they visit the Hill-folk again in the future, they will be welcomed as honoured guests. In saving them, they have gained a potential refuge for future expeditions into the dark lands of Rhudaur.

The discovery and defeat of such a formidable foe as Garaf is a tale that should not be kept silent. The Company must inform their Patron of all that has transpired. With their bravery and skill already proven, new adventures surely await the Player-heroes, a chance to further explore the rich and perilous landscapes of Middle-earth.

Hakmogg, Orc Hunter

Medium humanoid (Orc)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	9 (–1)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)

ARMOUR CLASS 17 (mail-shirt, shield)
HIT POINTS 16

LANGUAGES Orkish, Westron

SUNLIGHT SENSITIVITY. While in sunlight, Hakmogg has Disadvantage on attack rolls.

ACTIONS

On his turn, Hakmogg uses either his Scimitar or his Spear.

SCIMITAR. Melee Attack: +4 to hit. *Hit:* d6+2 slashing damage.

SPEAR. Melee Attack: +4 to hit. *Hit:* d6 + 2 piercing damage.

Goblin Archer

Small humanoid (Orc)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
11 (+0)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	8 (–1)

ARMOUR CLASS 13 (orc-leather)
HIT POINTS 9

SKILLS Stealth +4, Perception +2
LANGUAGES Orkish, Westron

SUNLIGHT SENSITIVITY. While in sunlight, a Goblin Archer has Disadvantage on attack rolls.

ACTIONS

On its turn, a Goblin Archer uses either a Jagged Knife or a Bow of Horn.

JAGGED KNIFE. Melee Attack: +4 to hit. *Hit:* d4+2 slashing damage.

BOW OF HORN. Ranged Attack: +4 to hit, up to Long range. *Hit:* d6+2 piercing damage.

Wild Wolf

Medium beast

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	5 (–3)	12 (+1)	7 (–2)

ARMOUR CLASS 13 (natural armour)
HIT POINTS 16

LANGUAGES Warg-speech

ACTIONS

BITE. Melee Attack: +4 to hit. *Hit:* d6+2 piercing damage, and the next attack roll made against the target has Advantage if made before the start of the next round.

Orc Soldier

Medium humanoid (Orc)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
13 (+1)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	9 (–1)	10 (+0)	9 (–1)

ARMOUR CLASS 15 (orc-leather, shield)
HIT POINTS 11

LANGUAGES Orkish, Westron

SUNLIGHT SENSITIVITY. While in sunlight, the Orc Soldier has Disadvantage on attack rolls.

ACTIONS

On its turn, an Orc Soldier uses either a Scimitar or a Spear.

SCIMITAR. Melee Attack: +4 to hit. *Hit:* d6+2 slashing damage.

SPEAR. Melee Attack: +3 to hit. *Hit:* d6+1 piercing damage.

Orc Guard

Medium humanoid (Orc)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
15 (+2)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	8 (–1)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)

ARMOUR CLASS 17 (orc-mail, shield)
HIT POINTS 26

SKILLS Perception +2
LANGUAGES Orkish, Westron

SUNLIGHT SENSITIVITY. While in sunlight, the Orc Guard has Disadvantage on attack rolls.

ACTIONS

On its turn, an Orc Guard uses either a Scimitar or a Spear.

SCIMITAR. Melee Attack: +4 to hit. *Hit:* d6+2 slashing damage.

SPEAR. Melee Attack: +4 to hit. *Hit:* d6+2 piercing damage.

Garaf, the Fang of the North

Large beast

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
17 (+3)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	7 (–2)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)

ARMOUR CLASS 14 (natural armour)
HIT POINTS 76

SKILLS Perception +5, Intimidation +4
LANGUAGES Warg-speech

ACTIONS

On her turn, Garaf uses either her Bite or her Dreadful Howl.

BITE. Melee Attack: +5 to hit. *Hit:* 2d6+3 piercing damage, and the next attack roll made against the target has Advantage if made before the start of the next round.

DREADFUL HOWL. Garaf lets out a chilling howl. Each Player-hero in the fight gains 2 Shadow points, resisted by a DC 15 Charisma saving throw. On a failed save, a Player-hero is Frightened until the start of Garaf's next turn, meaning they have Disadvantage on all ability checks and attack rolls.

Michael Sweett (Order #53484556)

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